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Roland EJ-640

5 reasons why no to buy

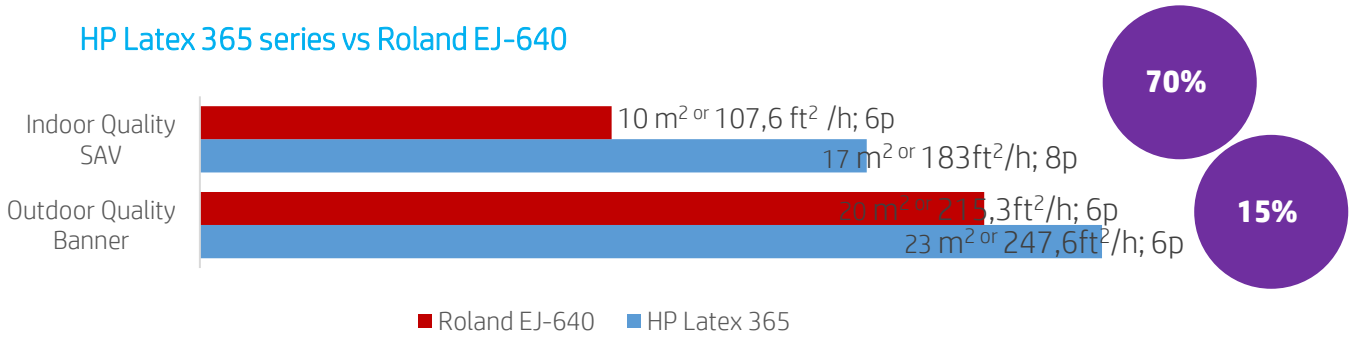
5 reasons why not to buy... Roland EJ-640

1. Trade-off between quality and productivity required

Roland EJ-640 is a printer that has to be configured at the very beginning as a productivity printer (4c) or as a high quality printer (7c). This means that EJ-640 will never print at high quality and high speed.

On top of that, HP latex 365 is still 70% faster compared to EJ-640 productivity configuration!

HP Latex 365 series vs Roland EJ-640



2. Longer turnaround time: no instant dry

Roland EJ inks have poor scratch resistance. Lamination is required to prevent accidental damages. In order to laminate with solvent technologies, 24 hours media degass is required.

In order to increase productivity, manufacturer recommends the installation of the optional heater and blower for every printer configured with 4 colors.

3. Quality not consistent over time due to printhead degradation

Piezoelectric printheads tend to have a 1 to 2 year lifespan, but they require intense manual maintenance to achieve this long productive life. Even with this time-consuming maintenance, printheads will deteriorate as time goes by continuously dropping the quality of prints.

4. Cannot print on uncoated materials

Application versatility on Roland is not as good as on HP Latex printers, Roland cannot print with the same quality on uncoated materials. The print is not deliverable.

5. Hazardous inks that require special precaution

Roland EJ-640 uses an eco-solvent ink (EJ inks) as printing technology. Eco stands for economic not for ecologic. The **ink carries a hazardous solvent** which help the pigment penetrate the media and then it evaporates, emitting dangerous gases as stated by Roland itself.

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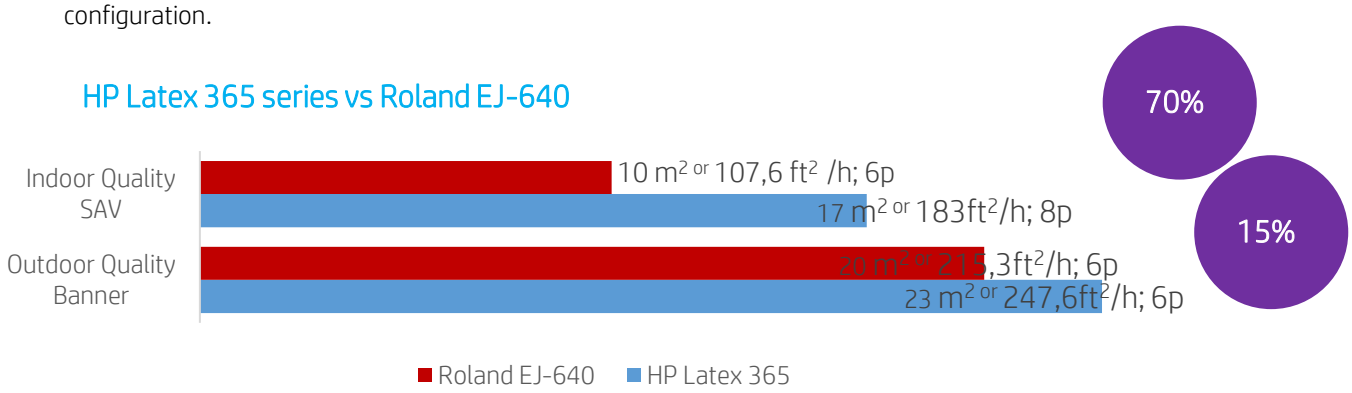
1. Trade-off between quality and productivity required

Despite being an evolution of the 3 year-old printer Roland XF-640, technology is still the same, which makes Roland EJ-640 a printer that has to be configured at the very beginning as a productivity printer (4c) or as a high quality printer (7c) in order to have an added value to the previous version.

This means that as its predecessor, EJ-640 will never print at high quality and high speed at a time.

On top of that, HP latex 365 is still up to 70% faster compared to EJ-640 productivity configuration!

Once the printer has been installed and the configuration has been chosen, you cannot change it to another configuration.



2. Longer turnaround time: no instant dry

On HP Latex durable prints come out completely dry and scratch resistant, ready to finish and deliver.

For Roland eco-solvent printer's lamination is required, as it has a poor scratch resistance. This will lead to the need to degas the samples before laminating, if not, formation of gas bubbles can appear causing a quality problem to end users.

The additional finishing time is a problem with the short turnaround of the industry. The customer might lose the job with Roland.

3. Quality not consistent over time due to printhead degradation

Piezo electric printheads are expensive, but they tend to have a long lifespan. This means that user needs printheads to be reliable and that printheads continue printing with the same quality after 1 or 2 years. In order to achieve this reliability, time consuming maintenance has to be performed weekly.

Even with this time consuming maintenance, **printheads will continue to deteriorate** as time goes by, and the drops won't be fired in the same way print after print deriving in print quality issues.

On the other hand, HP latex printheads are cheaper and have to be changed more frequently, plus they do not require any kind of maintenance and print **quality will always be the same as the first print**.

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4. Cannot print on uncoated materials

UNCOATED PAPERS

Roland EJ-640 HP Latex 365

UNCOATED TEXTILES

Roland EJ-640 HP Latex 365

UNCOATED WALL COVERINGS

Roland EJ-640 HP Latex 365

Application versatility on Roland is not as good as on HP Latex printers, Roland cannot print with the same quality on uncoated materials. The print is not deliverable.

It cannot print on textiles without liner, because it does not have a protective layer to prevent the ink trespassing the media and not leaking into the printer platen or engines.

On the other hand, HP Latex printers are able to print on uncoated materials performing very well and being able to delivery prints with quality.

The HP Latex 365 comes with the HP latex ink collector, which allows to print on porous textiles such as flags or other often used signage applications.

5. Hazardous inks that require special precaution

Roland EJ-640 uses an eco-solvent ink (EJ inks) as printing technology. Eco stands for economic not for ecologic. The **ink carries a hazardous solvent** which help the pigment penetrate the media and then it evaporates, emitting dangerous gases as stated by Roland itself.

HP Latex inks have water as its main component and enable a healthier approach to signage printing with advantages from the work zone to the point-of-display of finished prints. HP Latex inks have an extensive range of third party certifications and continues to have the best environmental profile of any solution in the marketplace, no special ventilation required, have low odor and low VOC, no HAPs, nickel free.

HP water-based technology

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Technical specifications Comparison

		HP Latex 365	Roland EJ-640
Estimated street prices[1]		Contact your country sales representative for prices	$ 26.640/€ 23.900
Technology	HP Thermal Inkjet HP Wide Scan Printing Technology		Piezo ink jet drop-on-demand
Printing	Printing modes	5 m²/hr (54 ft²/hr) – High Saturation Textiles (20-pass)	4 colors 10 m²/hr (108 ft²/hr) – 720x720 (12-pass)
		6.4 m²/hr (69 ft²/hr) - Backlits, Textiles, and Canvas (16-pass)	15 m²/hr (161 ft²/hr) – 720x720 (8-pass)
		14 m²/hr (147 ft²/hr) - Indoor High Quality (10pass)	20 m²/hr (215 ft²/hr) – 720x720 (6-pass)
		17 m²/hr (184 ft²/hr) – Indoor Quality (8-pass)	24 m²/hr (258 ft²/hr) – 720x720 (5-pass)
		23 m²/hr (245 ft²/hr) – Outdoor Plus (6-pass)	31 m²/hr (334 ft²/hr) – 360x720 (4-pass)
		23 m²/hr (245 ft²/hr) – Outdoor Economy (6p4c80%)	63 m²/hr (678 ft²/hr) – 540x360 (2-pass)
		31 m²/hr (335 ft²/hr) – Outdoor High Speed (4p4c80%))	7 colors 5.5 m²/hr (59 ft²/hr) – 720x1440 (20-pass)
		65.5 m²/hr (705 ft²/hr) – Billboard (2p4c50%)	6 m²/hr (65 ft²/hr) – 720x1440 (18-pass)
			10 m²/hr (108 ft²/hr) – 720x720 (12-pass)
			12 m²/hr (129 ft²/hr) – 720x720 (10-pass)
			15 m²/hr (161 ft²/hr) – 360x720 (8-pass)
	Print resolution	1200 x 1200 dpi	1440 dpi
	Base color configuration	CMYKLcLm	Roland EJ ink. 4 or 7 color config. CMYKlclmlk / CMYKKYMC
	Cartridge size	775 ml / 3000 ml	1l
Media	Handling	Roll feed, take-up reel, automatic cutter (for vinyl, paper-based media, backlit polyester film)	Roll feed, sheet feed, and take-up reel, X cutter.
	Roll size	25 to 162-cm (10 to 64-in) rolls (580 to 1625mm (23 to 64-in) rolls with full support)	25.9 to 162.5-cm (10.2 to 64-in) rolls,
	Roll weight	42 kg (92.6 lb)	Up to 40 kg (88 lb)
	Roll diameter	Up to 25-cm (9.8-in)	Up to 21-cm (8.3-in) outside diameter
	Thickness	Up to 0.5 mm (19.7 mil)	Up to 1.0 mm (39 mil) with liner
Connectivity	Interfaces (standard	Gigabit Ethernet (1000Base-T)	Ethernet (10BASE-T/100BASE-TX, automatic switching)
Durability[2]	Outdoor display: up to 3 years unlaminated, 5 years laminated. Indoor display: up to 5 years unlaminated, 10 years laminated		Outdoor display: up to 3 years unlaminated.
RIP	HP Certified third-party RIP solutions		VersaWorks® RIP Software
Dimensions (w x d x h)	Printer: 2561 x 840 x 1380 mm (101 x 33 x 54 in) Shipping: 2795 x 765 x 1239 mm (110 x 30.1 x 48.8 in)		2750 x 1520 x 785 mm (108 x 59.9 x 31 in)
Weight	Printer: 207 kg (456 lb), Shipping: 295 kg (649 lb)		220 kg (485 lb)
Warranty[3]	One-year limited hardware warranty		Standard one-year, on-site, limited warranty and usually next-business-day service with tollfree phone support Monday through Friday

*HW prices obtained from manufacturer's website. Supplies prices for CpC obtained from averages from ten different countries. CpC results using OEM inks priced at 180$/l. Ink consumption computed in Indoor quality mode (12p Roland EJ and 8p HP Latex 365) and reducing it by 30% as stated by manufacturer.

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